

GROWTH ON GAS

Pankaj Kumar's management practices have helped GSPL become the country's second-largest natural gas company

By **Manish Pant**



RIDING HIGH Pankaj Kumar, CMD, Gujarat State Petronet

► **IN HIS OVER** three-decade career as a bureaucrat, Pankaj Kumar has shouldered responsibilities in revenue, home, health, agriculture and disaster management departments in various capacities in Gujarat. This diverse exposure is serving him well in his current role as the state Chief Secretary as well as Chairman & Managing Director of the state-government-owned gas transmission company Gujarat State Petronet Ltd (GSPL).

GSPL was established by the Gujarat government in 1998 to develop a state-wide gas grid that would connect supply sources and demand markets. Since its inception, the company's end objective has been to support the efforts of its parent, Gujarat State Petroleum Corp. (GSPC), which at that time was primarily engaged in oil and gas exploration and gas trading, to develop a robust gas market in the western state.

In the past decade, as the 10-company strong and ₹20,000-crore turnover GSPC group has gradually retracted from exploration and production activities, GSPL has catalysed Gujarat's transformation into a gas-based economy. With over 2,700 km of natural gas pipelines covering the state's 25 districts, GSPL is India's second-largest natural gas transmission infrastructure company. Kumar is the winner in the Oil & Gas category of the BT-PwC India's Best CEOs ranking.

"GSPL is the only pure-play natural gas transmission

Key Highlights

- ➊ With over 2,700 km of natural gas pipelines, GSPL is India's second-largest natural gas transmission infrastructure company
- ➋ Efficient management practices have made the company largely debt-free
- ➌ Completion of the second phase of the 1,650-km Mehsana-Bhatinda pipeline remains a priority
- ➍ GSPL plans to invest ₹4,300 crore in adding more than 1,000 km to its pipeline network
- ➎ As a result of GSPL's targeted initiatives, the share of natural gas in Gujarat's primary fuel mix is over 25%

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